

Staff Code of Conduct

Expected standards of professional behaviour

15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE · Alternative Provision for Ages 5–25

ADOPTED POLICY

This policy has been formally adopted by L-Fit Pathways' co-directors and is in effect from the date shown below. Any section still shown in [square brackets and amber text] is organisation-specific detail that remains to be confirmed and inserted - it does not affect the rest of the policy's validity but should be completed as soon as possible.

Version: 1.0 (Adopted)

Date Adopted: 16 September 2026

Next Review Due: 16 September 2027 (or sooner following any legislative change or relevant incident)

1. Statement of Intent

This Code of Conduct sets out the standards of behaviour expected of everyone working at L-Fit Pathways, including the Co-Directors, sessional staff and volunteers, in line with KCSIE 2026 Part 4 (Managing Allegations) and Part 5 (Child on Child Abuse), and DfE guidance on staff behaviour and low-level concerns.

2. Legal & Good Practice Framework

- Keeping Children Safe in Education (KCSIE) 2026, Part 4
- DfE guidance on managing staff conduct and low-level concerns
- Working Together to Safeguard Children (2026)

3. Expected Standards

- Treat every young person with dignity, respect and warmth, and model the behaviour we expect from them
- Maintain professional boundaries at all times — no personal social media contact, no personal phone numbers exchanged, no gifts given or accepted outside agreed activities
- Never be alone with a young person in a way that cannot be observed or interrupted by another adult
- Never photograph a young person on a personal device — see our Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy
- Report any concern about a colleague's conduct, however small, to a Designated Safeguarding Lead — see 'Low-Level Concerns' below
- Never use physical punishment or degrading treatment of any kind
- Attend all required safeguarding, first aid and provision-specific training

4. Low-Level Concerns

A low-level concern is any behaviour by a staff member or volunteer that does not meet the threshold of harm but feels 'not quite right' — for example, over-familiarity with a young person, or a boundary that has been crossed unintentionally. Staff are encouraged to report low-level concerns to a DSL without fear of over-reacting; these are recorded and monitored to identify any pattern.

5. Allegations Against Staff

Any allegation that meets the harm threshold is managed under our Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy, including referral to the LADO where appropriate, independently of the individual concerned.

6. Roles & Responsibilities

All staff and volunteers sign to confirm they have read and understood this Code of Conduct as part of induction, before working unsupervised with young people.

7. Monitoring & Review

This policy is reviewed annually.

Policy adopted on: 16 September 2026 — Next review due: 16 September 2027